

information. Enabling encryption slows down the performance of GD2, though.

The UI is very much like the online search tool. Results are displayed in your browser; you can also search for an item on other Google networks such as Froogle, Local, Images and so on by right-clicking on the system tray icon and selecting the appropriate engine. Further, GD2 supports most of the syntax that Google's online search tool offers for better filtering of results.

Overall, Google Desktop 2 is *<the>* search tool for your desktop. Beginners might find the interface a little too rich; advanced users will love it!



Google
Sidebar

8.1.2 Copernic Desktop Search (CDS)

CDS was one of the first desktop search products - it came out much before Google or Yahoo! decided to enter the field. While Google Desktop features tight integration with IE for displaying results, Copernic displays results within its own explorer.

The user interface is clean and well-polished, and should pose no challenges for a beginner. In fact, the interface is pretty similar to standalone e-mail clients, and anybody who has used one will feel instantly at home with CDS.

The top bar consists of well-defined, self-explanatory icons. On the left-hand side you have the search box and the search filtering options. The right-hand pane is divided into a list box and a preview pane. The list box lists out all the results, and the preview pane shows the contents of the files - pretty useful.

CDS supports standard file types such as Word, Excel, PDF, text files, Java, XML, .ini, and most compressed files. It supports e-mail clients such as Outlook 2000/XP/2003, Outlook Express,